

AUSTRALIAN PAYROLL ASSOCIATION

Brand Guidelines

Version 2.0



APA Logo

THE LOGO



The APA logo is more than a visual signature; it reflects the organisation's purpose, values, and commitment to the payroll profession. By placing people at the centre of the design, it underscores APA's belief that payroll is ultimately about serving individuals with accuracy, fairness, and integrity. Its balanced form and professional style capture the association's mission to lead, support, and elevate payroll standards across Australia.

The typography, modern and structured, reflects professionalism and clarity. These are critical qualities in payroll practice. The balance of uppercase and spacing conveys strength, transparency, and approachability.

This logo is more than a visual mark. It is a daily reminder that payroll is more than just processing data. It is about people. It reflects APA's mission to create confidence in how people are paid across Australia.

BRANDMARK

ELEMENT	MEANING
Human Figure	People at the center of payroll
Two Arcs (Blue)	Connection between employer and employee
Golden Square (Head)	Value of individuals, leadership, and trust
Blue Color Palette	Stability, intelligence, and professionalism
Structured Typography	Clarity, consistency, and authority

At the heart of the Australian Payroll Association logo is a symbol designed to represent the people who are central to everything we do. The abstract graphic in the center, composed of two stylized, interlocking arcs topped by a golden square, forms the subtle outline of a human figure. This figure represents not just any person, but the collective workforce that payroll professionals support, manage, and empower every day.

The two arcs, rendered in differing shades of blue, stand for connection and balance. They represent both sides of the payroll equation: the organization and the employee. Their symmetrical, forward-facing forms suggest collaboration and trust, which are core values of the APA.

Above them, the golden square symbolizes the head of the human figure, representing leadership, integrity, and the value of every individual. Gold was chosen to highlight the importance and dignity of people in the payroll process. It is people, after all, who give meaning to numbers.



LOGO CLEAR SPACE

The minimum exclusion zone for the logo is one-eighth of the logo width.



LOGO VARIATION



LOGO USAGE

Primary Position: One of the four corners

In most instances the logo sits in one of the four corners of a layout.



LOGO USAGE

Secondary Position: Center top or bottom

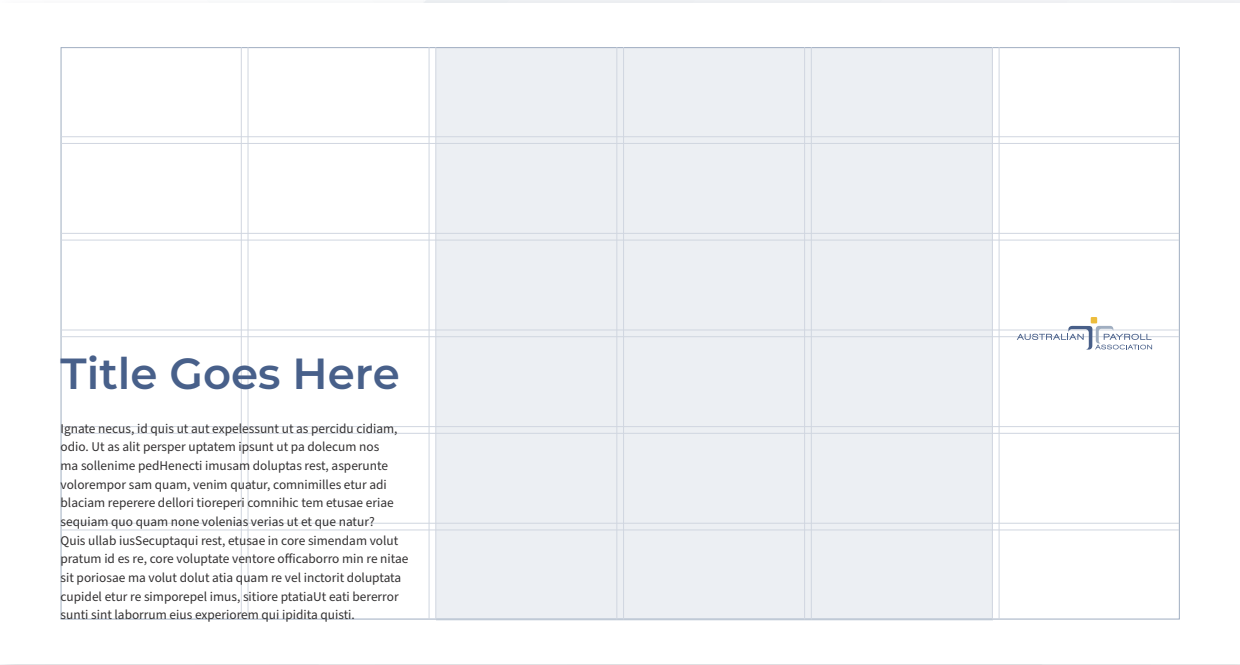
In layouts with center-aligned content, or with extreme vertical layouts, the logo can sit in the center top or bottom.



LOGO USAGE

Special Use Position: Center left or right

In content-heavy layouts or extreme horizontal layouts, the logo can sit in the center left or right.



LOGO USAGE

On social media we only use the brandmark for our avatar as it makes optimal use of the limited space for better impact.

App Icon



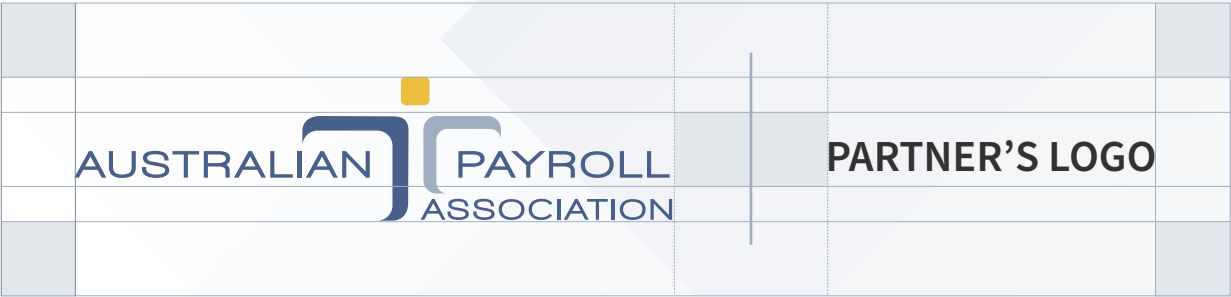
Sticker



*Alternative versions may be used.

Brand Collaboration

When positioning the APA logo alongside a partner or secondary logo, always maintain a minimum exclusion zone equal to one-eighth of the APA logo's width. A visual divider must be placed between the two logos to ensure clear separation and preserve brand integrity.



Divider line specifications:

- 1 inch length
- 1pt weight
- Colour:



LOGO MISUSE



Do not try to make your own version of the logo



Do not apply effects to the logo



Do not rotate the logo



Do not use an outlined version of the logo



Do not change the colour of the logo



Do not stretch the logo



Do not crop the logo



Do not place objects too close to the logo



Do not place on busy or patterned backgrounds



Don't apply gradient to logo



Do not use the mono logo in any other colour than black or white



Do not use against a background colour that is not accessible

APA Palette

APA COLOUR PALETTE

Primary palette – Print & Digital



RGB 255, 255, 255
CYMK 0, 0, 0, 0
HEX FFFFFFFF
Pantone 000 C
Websafe FFFFFFFF



RGB 72, 96, 138
CYMK 48, 30, 0, 46
HEX 48608a
Pantone 2154 U
Websafe 336699



RGB 217, 164, 40
CYMK 0, 24, 82, 15
HEX d9a428
Pantone 110 U
Websafe cc9933

For graphics and text only – Print & Digital



RGB 160, 174, 193
CYMK 17, 10, 0, 24
HEX a0aec1
Pantone 536 C
Websafe 9999cc



RGB 238, 189, 60
CYMK 0, 21, 75, 7
HEX eebd3c
Pantone 142 C
Websafe ffcc33



RGB 51, 50, 50
CYMK 0, 2, 2, 80
HEX 333232
Pantone P 179-15 C
Websafe 333333



RGB 41, 57, 77
CYMK 48, 21, 0, 62
HEX 324d61
Pantone 7546 C
Websafe 336666

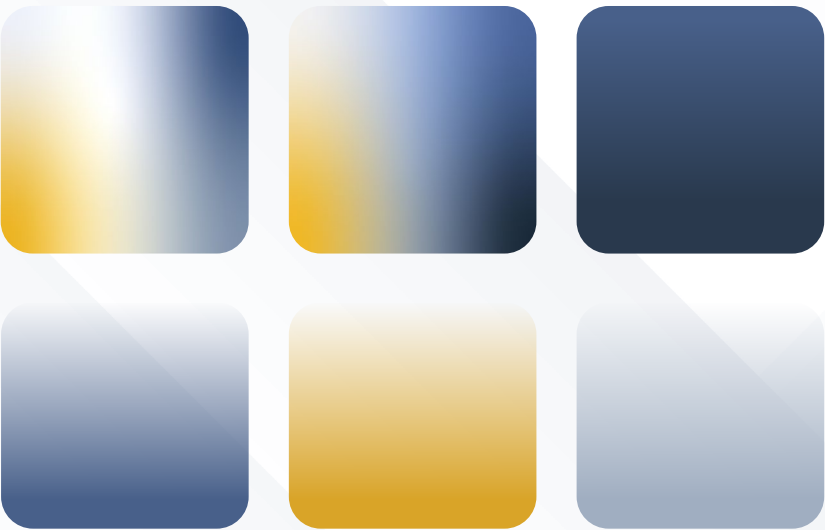


RGB 128, 136, 151
CYMK 15, 10, 0, 41
HEX 808897
Pantone 6220 UP
Websafe 999999

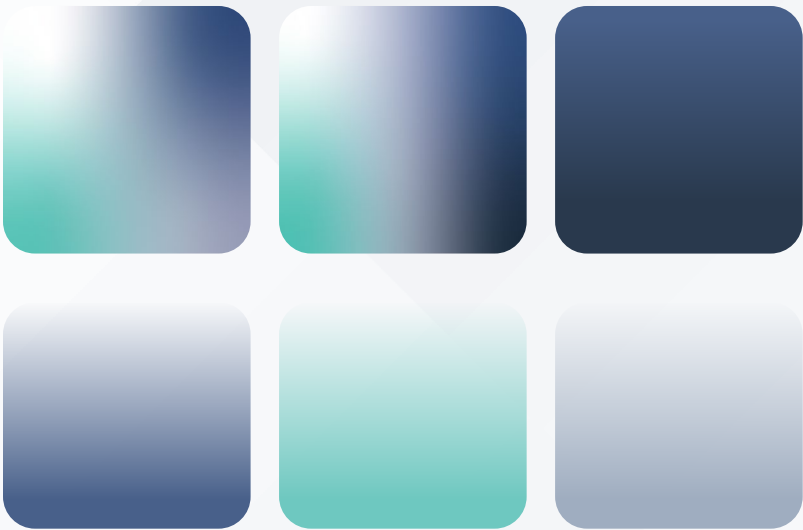
GRADIENTS

Gradients can be used as backgrounds only and as long as color is necessary and legibility is not compromised.

APA Gradients



Advisory Gradients



ADVISORY COLOUR PALETTE

Primary palette – Print & Digital



RGB 255, 255, 255
CYMK 0, 0, 0, 0
HEX FFFFFFFF
Pantone 000 C
Websafe FFFFFFFF



RGB 72, 96, 138
CYMK 48, 30, 0, 46
HEX 48608a
Pantone 2154 U
Websafe 336699



RGB 110, 200, 192
CYMK 45, 0, 4, 22
HEX 6ec8c0
Pantone 325 C
Websafe 66cccc

For graphics and text only – Print & Digital



RGB 160, 174, 193
CYMK 17, 10, 0, 24
HEX a0aec1
Pantone 536 C
Websafe 9999cc



RGB 69, 125, 120
CYMK 45, 0, 4, 51
HEX 457d78
Pantone 4166 C
Websafe 336666



RGB 51, 50, 50
CYMK 0, 2, 2, 80
HEX 333232
Pantone P 179-15 C
Websafe 333333



RGB 41, 57, 77
CYMK 47, 26, 0, 70
HEX 29394d
Pantone 2380 C
Websafe 333366



RGB 128, 136, 151
CYMK 15, 10, 0, 41
HEX 808897
Pantone 6220 UP
Websafe 999999

Typography

TYPOGRAPHY

Primary typeface

The primary typeface is exclusively applied to titles and Level 1 headers within social media posts and advertisements.

Montserrat Light
Montserrat Regular
Montserrat Semibold

Secondary typeface

Secondary typeface is used for document headers, body text, footers, and captions, except Source Sans Pro Light, which is reserved for titles Level 1 headers and at a minimum size of 36pt.

Source Sans Pro Light
Source Sans Pro Regular
Source Sans Pro Semibold

System typeface*

Century Gothic Regular
Century Gothic Bold

System typeface*

Calibri Regular
Calibri Bold

*PowerPoint, Word and MS Outlook templates use the system typeface Calibri and Century Gothic (For Title cover/headers only). This avoids any incompatibility issues when documents are sent out to third parties who do not have Montserrat and/or Source Sans Pro. It ensures documents are seen as we intend them.

TYPOGRAPHY USAGE

Colours to use:



Titles • Titles

Montserrat Semibold or Source Sans Pro Light • 32–72 pt and 36–80 pt leading



HEADING 1

Source Sans Pro, Semibold • 22–28 pt and 26–32 pt leading



Heading 2

Source Sans Pro, Regular • 18–20 pt and 22–24 pt leading



Heading 3

Source Sans Pro, Semibold • 14–16 pt and 18–20 pt leading



Body copy

Source Sans Pro, Regular • 10–12 pt and 14–16 pt leading



Footer, notes or captions

Source Sans Pro, Regular • 8 pt and 12 pt leading

TYPOGRAPHY

Do's and Don'ts

FONT WEIGHT USAGE

While you have the flexibility to choose the most suitable font weight for your communication, it is essential to adhere to some general rules, which are:

- Opt for the Semibold font weight for headings (excluding headlines/titles) and whenever emphasis on specific wording for body copy is necessary. Avoid using bold and italic.
- Source Sans Pro Light is only used for expressive typographic use with big font size (30pt and above)

CASE

The default case is sentence case, while title case is reserved for product names, service names, and proper titles. The use of 'all caps' in copy is discouraged, but it can be employed sparingly as a design element in headlines and subheads.

ALIGNMENT

Default alignment of text should be left-aligned and never right-aligned or justified for body copy. Text can be centered when using small blocks of copy such as infographics, table headings, etc. and right-aligned for ads, banners, etc.

PUNCTUATION

- Hyphen

The hyphens (-) only to join compound words, without spaces on either side. Do not use hyphens to split single words.

- En dash

The en dash (–) is used when representing a range of dates, number or time. There should be no space between the en dash and the adjacent word. (E.g., Chapters 2–3, \$200–\$400, 2023–2024)

- Em dash

The em dash (—) can be used to take the place of commas, parentheses, colons and semicolons, in each case to a slightly different effect. Use the em dash in sentences to create a break or show an interruption—or emphasis.

LARGE NUMERALS

Numbers exceeding 1,000 should incorporate commas for enhanced readability. It is crucial to employ a comma and not a space, as screen readers may interpret numerals separated by a space as distinct numbers.

Imagery

IMAGERY

Australian Payroll Association Image Library

APA's internal image library must be the primary source for all design and marketing materials. It reflects the organization's preference for authentic, people-focused visuals that often include real employees. This supports the APA brand tone of voice—genuine, inclusive, candid, authentic, and professional. Stock images may only be used when no suitable internal imagery is available.



IMAGERY

Stock Photos

User-generated content (UGC) contributes a personal, relatable, and emotionally engaging layer to APA's visual system. It offers an opportunity to showcase authentic experiences and everyday moments that feel real to our audience. It should consistently reflect natural lighting and organic composition, avoiding heavy edits, artificial filters, or overly stylized treatments. The intention behind using this type of content is to highlight honest, experience-driven interactions that align with the brand's values of authenticity, inclusivity, and approachability.

Content should feel candid rather than posed, with subjects appearing comfortable, confident, and at ease in their environment. The overall mood of the imagery should evoke spontaneity and warmth, never feeling forced, staged, or overly produced. When thoughtfully curated, UGC can strengthen brand trust and emotional connection by presenting APA as both human and relatable.

Images resources:

- Freepik
- Envato
- Unsplash
- Free Adobe Stock Photos



Iconography

OUR ICONS

Icon Styles

APA's iconography is designed to reflect a modern, refined, and approachable brand personality. Icons use a light line weight to maintain a sophisticated and elegant appearance. Heavier or overly bold strokes are avoided to prevent a rigid or overly technical look.

Subtle broken lines are incorporated into the icons to add character and uniqueness. This detail contributes to a distinctive style that supports APA's tone of voice, which is professional, authentic, and relatable.



There are two approved icon variations:

- **Standalone Icons** are used without a surrounding shape. This style is suitable for open or informal layouts and conveys a sense of lightness and flexibility.
- **Encircled Icons** are placed within a circular outline. This format is used to create emphasis or establish consistency in more structured layouts. Circles may use either primary or secondary brand colors based on the design context.

Both styles follow the same design principles and should be applied consistently to ensure a cohesive and recognizable visual system.